VPN (GlobalProtect) Installation and Connection Guide

A step-by-step guide to remotely connect to internal University network services using the Virtual Private Network (VPN).

Overview

To help protect University systems and data, some online services are only available through the University's Virtual Private Network (VPN).

If you need to access a University resource remotely and find that it is unavailable, you may need to connect to the VPN using the GlobalProtect application.

If you are unsure whether a service requires VPN access, please contact your lecturer, the service owner, or the Service Desk.

Before You Start

Before installing GlobalProtect, ensure that:

- You have a stable internet connection.
- You know your University username and password.
- You are enrolled in Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
- You have the required rights to install GlobalProtect (If not you will need to contact the Service Desk)
- **If you are using a University issued device**, you are likely to already have GlobalProtect client installed. In that case **you may skip the first five steps** (Downloading to Installing), **go to** the Section headed **"Making the Connection".**

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Downloading GlobalProtect

Access the VPN Portal

Open your web browser and navigate to:

https://remote2.westminster.ac.uk

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Sign In

Sign in using your full University account in the following format:

username@westminster.ac.uk

Examples:

- w1234567@westminster.ac.uk
- mousem@westminster.ac.uk

Enter your University password when prompted.

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Complete Multi-Factor Authentication

After entering your credentials, complete the MFA challenge.

Recommended authentication methods:

1. Microsoft Authenticator (preferred)
2. Passkey Using FIDO 2.0 compatible device or Security key (most secure)
3. Google Authenticator or another TOTP authenticator

Please note:
Email and **SMS** authentication methods are less secure and **must no longer be used**

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Download the GlobalProtect Client

Download the GlobalProtect installer appropriate for your device:

- **Windows:** Windows 64-bit GlobalProtect Agent
- **macOS:** Mac 32/64-bit GlobalProtect Agent

Linux users please contact the Service Desk to request the appropriate installation package if required.



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Installing GlobalProtect

i. Locate the downloaded installation file.
ii. Run the installer.
iii. Follow the on-screen instructions to complete the installation.
iv. Open the **GlobalProtect** application once installation is complete.

Making the Connection

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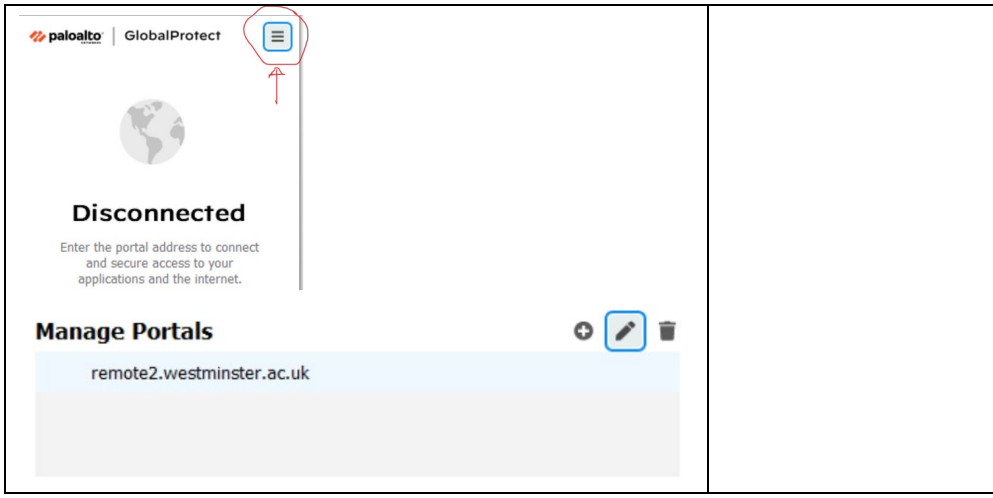
Start GlobalProtect

Open the GlobalProtect application.

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Select "Settings"

Click **Settings** by clicking on three lines in corner.



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Enter the Portal Address

In the **Portal** field, enter:

remote2.westminster.ac.uk

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Authenticate

A sign-in window will appear.

i. Enter your University username and password.

ii. Complete the MFA verification process.

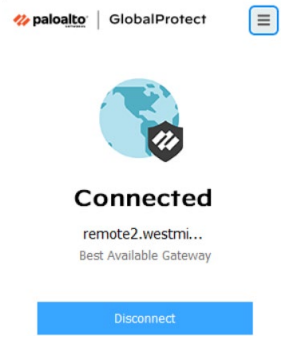
Wait (seconds) while GlobalProtect establishes a secure connection

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Confirming You're Connected

When the connection is successful:

- The GlobalProtect status will display **Connected**.



- You will be able to access University systems and services that require VPN access and use them as usual.

After setup tasks | Troubleshooting

- If you are unable to connect:

Check Your Credentials

- Ensure your University username and password are correct.
- Confirm your MFA method is working.

Verify the Portal Address

Ensure the following portal address has been entered correctly:

- remote2.westminster.ac.uk

Restart the Application

Close and reopen GlobalProtect before attempting to reconnect.

Also check the PanGPS service is running via task manager.

Contact the Service Desk

If the issue persists, contact the University Service Desk and provide:

- Your username
- Device type (Windows, macOS, or Linux)
- Any error messages displayed by GlobalProtect

Need Further Assistance?

If you require support with:

- Installing GlobalProtect
- MFA enrolment
- Accessing the University's services remotely
- Linux client downloads

Please raise a ticket with the University Service Desk for assistance via this URL:
https://servicedesk.westminster.ac.uk/